

ANTIA TALAB, JHANSI



Antia Talab is said to have been constructed during the reign of the Chandela rulers between the 10th and 18th centuries. It is known to be one of the oldest sources of water for the residents of the densely populated city of Jhansi. The waterbody is located in the heart of Jhansi city, surrounded by temples, dense residential areas, and commercial establishments. The size of Antia Talab is approximately 9.5 acres and it has a trapezoidal shape.



Key Challenges:

- Septic condition
- Water quality
- Availability of water throughout the year
- Financial sustainability
- Solid waste management



Solutions:

- Decentralized nature-based treatment system (DNTS) to ensure availability of continuous treated water
- Desilting to increase the water-holding capacity of the lake and dewatering for better water quality

- In-situ aeration to improve water quality and maintain dissolved oxygen levels
- Financial sustainability through increased public engagement via boating clubs and cafeteria areas
- Nutrient reduction to improve water quality and increase biodiversity around the waterbody



Benefits of the Waterbody:

- Improvement in groundwater levels due to recharge
- Enhancement of aesthetic value and reduction of unhygienic conditions for nearby residents
- Development as a tourism hotspot and recreational space for locals
- Acts as a buffer during heavy rainfall or flooding
- Helps regulate microclimatic conditions and provides a pleasant environment



Key Highlights

- Increased footfall in a short period of time
- Presence of fish, ducks, and other aquatic life indicating reduced pollution
- Increase in the number of birds in the vicinity
- Rise in revenue for the Nagar Nigam
- Improved community health and well-being
- Serves as a model for good governance